The GROWTH Execution Model™

One model. Every conversation. Real results.

Six steps for any conversation with an agenda. With people, and with agents.

From ***AI Will Scale Good Leadership and Bad Leadership:*** *The CHRO's Method for Redesigning Work Before AI Scales What's Broken* by Liz Corey · Toolbox No. 11

	STEP AND QUESTION	AI	LEADER	SAID TO A PERSON	WRITTEN TO AI
G	**Goal** What outcome are we here to achieve?	**AI strengthens** Drafts and contextualizes	**Leader owns** Chooses the goal, owns the why	*"I want us to leave with a plan you believe you can hit."*	*"Draft a plan to close the two open roles by March. Success looks like offers accepted, not candidates sourced."*
R	**Reflect** What is happening?	**AI strengthens** Assembles the record	**Leader owns** Names the truth, including the part they created	*"What does the data show, and what happened versus what was supposed to happen?"*	*"Pull the last three months of pipeline data and the commitments from our last review. Flag anything that changed."*
O	**Options** What choices exist? If you had a magic wand, what might you do?	**AI strengthens** Widens the set, challenges assumptions	**Leader owns** Imagines first, evaluates last	*"Before we pick, what are three genuinely different paths, including the uncomfortable ones?"*	*"Here are the two options we see. What else should we consider, and what does each one assume?"*
W	**What's Next** What will we decide, and who owns it?	**AI strengthens** Captures and routes	**Leader owns** Decides and owns	*"So the decision is X. You own it. It's due the 15th. Say it back to me."*	*"Record the decision, the owner, and the date. Draft the follow-up note for my review."*
T	**Tracking** What steps get us to the due date, how will progress be visible, and where will it be hardest?	**AI strengthens** Watches and flags	**Leader owns** Responds, holds accountable	*"Where will this get hard, and what's the plan for that moment?"*	*"Watch these three signals weekly. Flag me the first week any of them drifts."*
H	**Habits** What behaviors must be sustained?	**AI strengthens** Reinforces at the moment of need	**Leader owns** Sustains and models	*"For this to hold, what do we keep doing after today, and what skill do we build?"*	*"Before each of my one-on-ones, remind me of the open commitments and the pattern worth knowing."*

The bright line. AI strengthens the step. The leader owns the step.

The same discipline. A better prompt and a better conversation turn out to be the same discipline.

The assignment structure. Every request to AI, like every goal to a person, has four parts: **Goal** (the outcome it serves), **Context** (what it cannot know), **Constraints** (what it must not do, and what comes back to you), **Output** (what finished looks like). Writing an effective goal and writing an effective prompt are nearly the same skill.

Grace + Grit™, inside every step. Grace is relational precision: hard truth without destroying trust. Grit is structural resolve: hold the line and have the conversation everyone else is avoiding. Grace without grit creates drift. Grit without grace creates erosion.

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POWERFUL QUESTIONS

Open, not closed. “How well,” not “did you.”

Every step in GROWTH turns on a question, and the quality of the question determines the quality of the conversation. Closed questions confirm an activity. Powerful questions uncover assumptions, expose gaps, and leave the thinking and the accountability with the person responsible for the result. The same is true when you are asking AI: powerful questions make it show its work, so you can evaluate the answer instead of accepting it.

GETS A YES OR A NO	REQUIRES JUDGMENT
“Did you finish the analysis?”	**“What did the analysis tell you?”**
“Did you check the source?”	**“How thoroughly did you validate the source, and what gives you confidence in its accuracy?”**
To AI: “Is this analysis right?”	**To AI: “What did you assume, and which assumption would change the answer if it were wrong?”**
To AI: “Summarize this policy.”	**To AI: “Where does this policy leave room for interpretation, and how might two managers apply it differently?”**

Questions you can lift, by step

Goal

- What outcome does this conversation exist to produce?
- What would make this a success in your eyes?
- If we get this right, what changes?

Reflect

- What happened versus what was supposed to happen?
- What is the employee experiencing that the dashboard doesn’t capture?
- What part of this did I create?

Options

- If you had a magic wand, what might you do?
- What else should we consider, and what does each path assume?
- Which options have the greatest potential, and why?

What’s Next

- What are we deciding, and who owns it?
- What is the most powerful next step?
- What will you say back to me so I know we agree?

Tracking

- What steps get us to the due date?
- How will we both see progress, and when?
- Where will this be hardest, and what is the plan for that moment?

Habits

- For this to hold, what must we keep doing after today?
- How will we make that repetition easy?
- What skill or behavior will we develop?

The pivotal difference. A model that tells leaders what to say produces scripts. A model built on powerful questions develops judgment.

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RUN ONE CONVERSATION

The six questions, with room to answer them

Conversation: **With (person or agent):** **Date:**

G Goal
What outcome are we here to achieve?

R Reflect
What is happening?

O Options
What choices exist? If you had a magic wand, what might you do?

The person imagines first. AI expands. The person evaluates. The leader adds theirs last.

W What's Next
What will we decide, and who owns it?

The decision: **Owner:** **Date:**

T Tracking
What steps get us to the due date, how will progress be visible, and where will it be hardest?

Steps to the due date

How progress will be visible, and when

Where it will be hardest, and the plan for that moment

H Habits
What behaviors must be sustained?

What we keep doing after today

What skill or behavior we build

Before anyone leaves: ☐ A decision, stated ☐ An owner, named ☐ A date, set ☐ Tracking opens the next conversation

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THE AI HARNESS MAP

One protocol, two workforces

A harness doesn't constrain the horse. It directs the power. GROWTH directs AI output through human judgment, accountability, and relational standards before it becomes a decision or an action. A human manager runs GROWTH as a conversation. An agent runs it as an operating loop, and the mapping to the Agent Job Description is nearly one to one.

IN THE AGENT JOB DESCRIPTION	IS THE AGENT'S
Its purpose statement	**Goal**
Its retrieval of current state	**Reflect**
Its generation of alternatives	**Options**
Its decision rights and escalation paths: decide within bounds, escalate beyond them, always with an owner	**What's Next**
Its review cadence	**Tracking**
Its instructions and boundaries, reinforced every cycle	**Habits**

THE BENEFITS AGENT	RUN THROUGH THE SIX STEPS
Goal	Its purpose statement: answer benefits questions correctly, first contact, from verified plan documents
Reflect	Its verified sources, and nothing else
Options and What's Next	Its recommend-for-approval tier, with a named owner
Tracking	Its weekly sample of fifty answers
Habits	The document reopened after every change

An escalation that arrives already structured. *"Here's the goal. Here's what is happening. Here are the options I see, for you to weigh. A decision is needed, and here's whose it is."* The manager receiving it thinks in the same six steps. Handoffs stop being translations.

Teach the agent too

1. Write its job description as the six steps. Purpose is Goal. Sources are Reflect. Decision rights are What's Next. Review cadence is Tracking.

2. Require escalations in GROWTH order. Goal, what is happening, options for a person to weigh, whose decision it is.

3. Reinforce the boundaries every cycle. That is the agent's Habits step. A change to the model or a source reopens the document.

GROWTH is trainable into both halves of the workforce. The mapping above is built and tested in a working agent, the GROWTH Execution Partner. The human half of the results below came first. The agent half is where the model goes next.

What it produced. At one private equity backed software company, from the day GROWTH was installed to the day the company was sold: employee engagement up 45 percent, leader effectiveness up 32 percent, voluntary turnover down 34 percent, on the same instrument across the same population. Every one of those results came from the human half of the workforce, before an agent ever ran a step.

The CHRO's move. Don't launch a training program. Change an agenda. Run your own staff meeting on GROWTH for one month: the agenda is the six questions, decisions leave with owners and dates, Tracking opens the next meeting. Then do the same with one business leader who trusts you. That's how an operating protocol installs: not announced, but demonstrated.

GROWTH Execution Partner. Available now. Walks a leader through all six steps for any conversation with an agenda. · Write Better Prompts. Coach People Better. The 90-minute workshop. · GROWTH Application Guides. 27 guides, one per conversation type, from performance conversations to board preparation. Call for pricing. Book a conversation at onthegrow.ai

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